



Medford City Council
Medford, Massachusetts

Committee of the Whole, September 30, 2026

City Council

Isaac B. "Zac" Bears
Anna Callahan
Emily Lazzaro
Matt Leming
Liz Mullane
George A. Scarpelli
Justin Tseng

This meeting will take place at 6:00 P.M. in the City Council Chamber, 2nd Floor, Medford City Hall, 85 George P. Hassett Drive, Medford, MA and via Zoom.

Zoom

Link: <https://us06web.zoom.us/j/81788515237?pwd=KvXKSFWiZMbB81fL6HT8Ya9sskom8C.1>

Call-in Number: +19292056099,,81788515237#,,,,*353040# US (New York)

Live: Channel 22 (Comcast), Channel 43 (Verizon), [YouTube](#), and medfordtv.org.

To submit written comments, please email ccmembers@medford-ma.gov.

CALL TO ORDER & ROLL CALL

ACTION AND DISCUSSION ITEMS

24-033 - Offered by by Isaac Bears, Council President

Zoning Ordinance Updates - Zoning Consultant RFP

Adjournment



Medford City Council
Medford, Massachusetts

MEETING DATE

September 30, 2026

SPONSORED BY

AGENDA ITEM

24-033 - Zoning Ordinance Updates - Zoning Consultant RFP

FULL TEXT AND DESCRIPTION

RECOMMENDATION

FISCAL IMPACT

ATTACHMENTS

- I. Zoning Consultant RFP 2026-09-24



**LEGAL NOTICE
CITY OF MEDFORD
REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL
RFP xx-xxxx**

Consultant to Prepare a Comprehensive Update/Revision of the City's Zoning Ordinance

Note: dates listed in the document may change depending on when final approval of this draft is. Dates are highlighted in yellow. Will change dates just prior to final approval.

The City of Medford, led by the Medford City Council and Office of Planning, Development, and Sustainability, is accepting proposals for consultant to Prepare a Comprehensive Update/Revision of the City's Zoning Ordinance, for the city of Medford. Bid Documents will be available online beginning at **1:00 PM on Wednesday, July 1, 2026**, at <https://www.bidnetdirect.com/massachusetts/cityofmedford>. All Questions & Answers are due by **Wednesday, August 5, 2026 by 1:00 PM**. The Contract shall commence immediately upon signature of the contract and will end on or about two (2) years from the contract start date. The City will have the option to renew the contract for one (1), year extension with negotiated pricing and at the discretion of the City.

This project is being Electronically Bid (E-Bid). All proposals shall be submitted online to www.BidNetDirect.com prior to, **Thursday, August 19, 2026 by 1:00 PM**. Hard copy proposals will not be accepted by BidNetDirect.com. You can register to become a bidder (for free) online at www.BidNetDirect.com. For assistance, contact BidNetDirect.com at: 1-800-835-4603.

Proposers shall submit a technical, or non-price proposal which includes everything responsive to this RFP. This technical, or non-price should be clearly marked "**RFP 23-0001 Technical Proposal**." The price proposal shall be submitted in a separate electronic file and should be clearly marked "**RFP 23-0001 Price Proposal**." Seven (7) bound copies of the Technical Proposal are required to be delivered to the Office of Procurement, Room 105, Attention Fiona Maxwell on or before **Thursday, August 19, 2026, 1:00 PM**.

Each Proposal shall be submitted in accordance with the Submission Requirements within the RFP and M.G.L. c. 30B, §6 shall apply to this project. It is the responsibility of prospective proposers to check www.BidNetDirect.com for new information via any addenda to this solicitation. Any addenda issued will be emailed to all plan holders registered with BidNetDirect.

The City of Medford reserves the right to accept any proposal, in whole or in part, to reject any/or all proposals and to waive minor irregularities and/or informalities as it deems to be in the best interest of the City. The city is an Equal Opportunity Employer and encourages MBE/WBE/DBE participation in response to the bid process.

Fiona Maxwell

Chief Procurement Officer

DECISION TO USE COMPETITIVE SEALED PROPOSALS

The Chief Procurement Officer has determined that, in order to select the most advantageous proposal for consulting services support for the continuation of the Zoning Redesign Project, comparative judgments of technical factors, in addition to price, will be necessary for the following reasons:

1. The City requires dedicated consultants to review the Medford Comprehensive Plan and new zoning adopted and drafted since 2022, to help the City of Medford update the Zoning Ordinance to align with its goals for future planning and development.
2. The City requires specific expertise and experience in drafting zoning ordinances in urban/suburban communities.
3. The City requires experts to assist in the assessment of Zoning Laws applicable to existing and potential residential, commercial, and industrial properties, as well as educational and other Dover Amendment properties.

An Evaluation Committee appointed by the City Council and approved by the Mayor, shall review, evaluate, and rate each proposer's technical information. After this rating has been reviewed and accepted, the City will open price proposals. The City may invite the top proposer for an interview/presentation before an award is made. The City will award the contract to the proposer it determines most advantageous based on a detailed proposal, technical prowess, proposed price, and the presentation/interview.

PURPOSE

The purpose of this Request for Proposal is to seek proposals from qualified planning consultants to assist the City, City Council, the Office of Planning, Development & Sustainability ("PDS") and the Building Commissioner to revise and update the Zoning Ordinance & Map (together "Zoning") for the City of Medford, Massachusetts to better align with the City's vision and goals as well as the new Comprehensive Plan, Housing Production Plan, Climate Action and Adaptation Plan, Open Space Plan, and Bicycle Infrastructure Master Plan. The revised and updated Zoning will serve as a regulatory document based on sustainable land use principles and goals and objectives of the Comprehensive Plan for the City of Medford. It is anticipated that this process will begin in February 2027.

CHARACTER OF THE AREA

The City of Medford is a suburban community of about 60,000 people located in the Greater Boston Area. Five miles northwest of Boston proper, it houses part of the Tufts University main campus and is near Somerville's Assembly Square and the Encore Boston casino. It has a land area of approximately 8.2 square miles, and its proximity to Boston, access to major roadways, public transportation, and Logan Airport make Medford an attractive option for its residents, businesses, and commuters with clear opportunities for transit-oriented development. The City of Medford borders the Cities of Malden

and Everett to the east, the City of Somerville to the south, the Town of Stoneham to the north, and the Towns of Winchester and Arlington to the west. Medford's neighborhoods each have their own character, style and needs, and wish to retain these distinctions. The city's industrial areas have stagnated in recent decades and need new and revised zoning to encourage modern growth. The city must retain commercial and industrial space for tax base purposes, while working towards other goals. Additionally, existing zoning does not match either the current development, or desired patterns, in many parts of the city.

BACKGROUND

The City of Medford's current Zoning Ordinance & Map was adopted in 1965 and prior to 2022 had been amended infrequently. The City Council undertook a recodification in 2022 that created a modern framework for the Zoning Ordinance, cleaned up conflicts and errors, and included some substantive changes but largely did not update the zoning districts, map, or use tables. The City's Planning Board is the Community Development Board. This Board, under the project management of the PDS Office, undertook a Comprehensive Planning Process in 2021 and 2022, resulting in the city's first modern Comprehensive Plan. In 2023, the City hired Innes Land Strategies Group to assist in a zoning recodification effort, resulting in new zoning for Mystic Avenue, Salem Street, Boston Avenue, and Medford Square, as well as a Green Score. In November 2025, the City Council and Mayor agreed on a path forward for the zoning recodification effort that would additionally encompass zoning recodification for (1) a Tufts Institutional Zone; (2) Wellington/Mystic (3) Main Street and Broadway; Valley Parkway; (4) West Medford Square; (5) and Residential zoning, including residential parking, and (6) a comprehensive review of parking and a Transportation Demand Management Policy.

In April 2026, the City released an RFP for a communications consultant to assist in outreach for the Zoning Redesign. The selected consultant would be expected to collaborate with the selected communications consultant as well as City staff and stakeholders.

At this time the City Council and the Planning Office see that the zoning redesign needs to continue, since the City's pre-2022 zoning still reflects the planning desires of the 1960s and has not been completely updated to reflect current-day desires, goals, or best practices in urban planning as outlined in the Comprehensive Plan and other city planning documents. Medford's current zoning does not reflect the built environment in certain areas of the City and does not allow the desired built environment in other areas of the City.

Medford is looking for a consultant team that can continue the Zoning Redesign by providing planning support, modeling, and guidance as well as zoning legal counsel, in addition to working with a communications consultant on a comprehensive outreach effort. At the time of this RFP, the city is between in-house legal counsel and requires that legal support through the consulting team.

FUNDING SOURCE

The project will be funded by the City of Medford's general fund.

SCOPE OF SERVICES

The Consultant team shall prepare the City of Medford Zoning Ordinance update/revision(s) under the guidance of the City Council and Community Development Board, in conjunction with the Director of Planning, Development & Sustainability and the Building Commissioner. A working group comprised of members of the City Council, the Community Development Board and City Staff will direct the project. The Zoning Ordinance update/revision shall represent the community's vision for the City of Medford as detailed in the recently adopted Comprehensive Plan and other city planning documents.

The Consultant team will work in tandem with a communications consultant and the City's communications office, on an outreach effort to continually gather feedback from residents, as well as help residents learn about and better understand zoning changes in the City.

Primary Work Product

This contract will result in proposals for Zoning Ordinance amendments for the City Council and Community Development Board to review and pass in accordance with a schedule agreed upon by the City Council and the Mayor. While the City understands the need for a full Zoning Ordinance and Map overhaul, given current development pressures, the City prefers to take a phased approach being thoughtful and deliberate in each section of the city rather than one large change.

The work product specified here will be broken into multiple parts:

1. **Outreach:** Extensive outreach was done as part of the Comprehensive Plan, and assistance is now needed to codify recommendations, understand potential changes and flag potential unintended consequences. Public outreach during the Zoning Redesign process is expected to be a mixture of both gathering feedback from residents on more granular aspects of zoning changes and education on the complexities of zoning. Specifics of the outreach process in terms of schedules and timelines are shown in "Public Process", below. In collaboration with a communications consultant, the following specific products will be requested from the outreach process:
 - a. Simple language: Zoning Consultants will work with a communications consultant and city staff to break down the zoning changes in a way that clarifies and simplifies them to be understood by the average resident.
 - b. Quantification of public engagement. To quantify the overall success of the engagements process, consultants will be expected to record both the attendance at meetings and outreach events, as well as track the total number of unique speakers, writers, and public commenters in a spreadsheet across each given zoning initiative.
2. **Visualizations:** To help with understanding of the rezoning, the Consultants will incorporate the following, where applicable, into their presentations and public-facing documents. In addition to specific zoning language, the Consultant will provide best practice recommendations, massing and shadow studies, visuals, scenario planning of different options, and other information to assist the city in making broad zoning changes.
 - a. Presentations: The new Zoning Ordinance shall include layperson language text, plans, charts, graphs, diagrams, drawings and other applicable graphics to illustrate the

regulations. It also needs to be user friendly, with clear and concise language that affords its reader clear expectations with regards to any type of local development or planning activity. Particularly important in these presentations are use table updates for each district. Medford's zoning currently uses districts to primarily control uses. Dimensional requirements vary by use and are controlled by use category via a dimensional table. It is the intention of the city to have new zoning districts that control dimensions and uses. This change will likely include changing the locations and names of zoning districts and the format and content of existing tables.

- b. GIS: The City has adopted an electronic, GIS-based zoning map. The Consultant should have the resources to assist with this map and be prepared to incorporate recommended edits as a way to track old zoning, proposed changes, and adopted changes.
- c. Massing and shadow visualizations: When the zoning pertains to local districts, the consultant will use 3D software during meetings and presentations that shows both the effects of shadows with different building heights and helps the public better visualize different possibilities in the zoning. Throughout the project lifecycle, designated City staff will be provided shared access to the ArcGIS Urban models (and, if applicable, other mapping products and analyses generated in ArcGIS apps) used for scenario planning, visualizations, and any associated metric generation.

- 3. Cover letter for each zoning proposal: Cover letter should include information about what was changed, what else was considered, and where in the attached language to find that information. Anticipate that members of the Board will read the cover letter and review the zoning before the meeting.

- 4. **Content of the final zoning:** The rezoning is meant to incorporate previous plans, studies, and initiatives that the City of Medford has undertaken or shortly plans to undertake. It is also meant to modernize and clarify our current zoning laws. The following will be taken into account in the final zoning product:

- a. Sections of the new zoning. The rezoning process will be divided into at least six distinct areas that will be passed by the City Council as separate ordinance changes:
 - i. A Tufts Institutional Zone;
 - ii. Wellington/Mystic Valley Parkway;
 - iii. Main Street and Broadway;
 - iv. West Medford Square;
 - v. Residential zoning, including residential parking, and;
 - vi. A comprehensive review of parking and a Transportation Demand Management Policy.

When considering rezoning of localized areas, certain changes may be deemed universally applicable across the whole zoning ordinance rather than just one area. The consultants will track these changes in a separate working document, and, at the end of the zoning process, overall consolidation of such universal changes and fixes may be passed in a separate legislative package.

Commented [DE1]: The zoning ordinance should use clear and concise language, incorporate illustrative accompanying graphics, and all technical terms should be defined, however due to the complex nature of zoning, it isn't possible to use all layperson language in the ordinance.

Commented [DE2]: We recently were awarded an Eco One Stop grant (is the embargo lifted?) to study the residential neighborhoods which should provide data driven tailored recommendations for dimensional and development standards to harmonize housing production with climate resiliency goals (primarily to combat heat islands/flooding/stormwater runoff) such as pervious surface, tree canopy, steep slopes, heat island mitigation, etc)

- b. Implementation of previous plans and studies: The consultant will review existing plans, reports, and previous zoning changes, and work with staff and elected officials to determine needed changes to the zoning, with emphasis on the following:
- i. Comprehensive Plan: The Comprehensive Plan, which is the overall vision for the City of Medford released in 2023, has an implementation section on pages 195-206 that provides guidance on a path forward for zoning change. Proposers are expected to review that section and include a recommended process to finish its implementation in their proposal.
 - ii. Wellington Transformation Study: Input from the May 2026 Wellington Transformation Study will be incorporated into the Wellington/Mystic Valley Pkwy rezoning.
 - iii. West Medford Square SWOT analysis: The SWOT analysis will be incorporated into the West Medford Square rezoning.
 - iv. Housing Production Plan: New zoning is intended to encourage more residential development and affordable housing as outlined by Medford's Housing Production Plan.
 - v. Climate Action and Adaptation Plan: It is important to incorporate sustainability concepts/regulations throughout the code for rain gardens, solar panels, green roofs, bicycle parking, urban agriculture, etc. Whether mandatory or optional, these and other innovative solutions should be assimilated into the text of the Zoning Ordinance in a holistic and thoughtful manner.
 - vi. Upcoming Residential Zoning Climate Impact Study: The City was recently awarded an EEA Planning Assistance grant to study the existing characteristics of the natural and built environment in Medford's residential neighborhoods to inform residential zoning updates that balance the need for additional housing against the potential climate impacts specific to each neighborhood that may be created by new development. Per the terms of the grant, this study should be complete by June 30, 2027.
- c. De-conflicting language and overall consistency with recent rezoning efforts. City Staff have noted several conflicts in current zoning, missing definitions, inconsistent terminology, and difficult-to-understand use and dimensional tables. An early effort will be to provide legal language to correct these issues, while effort is being made to make larger scale zoning changes. The consultant will be responsible for the final work product and will be expected to correct any errors introduced through this process, identified within the first year after adoption. Other goals for the Zoning Ordinance are to ensure proper zoning districts are in place or created so development is appropriate in the context of the district and surrounding districts. The end result should provide for a more streamlined and improved document where unnecessary and contradictory standards have been removed and more opportunities for creative development, consistent goals, and policies will be facilitated.
- d. Mixed-use buildings: The City Council and Comprehensive Plan have identified a need to not only allow, but encourage, mixed-use buildings into the zoning. The new zoning should be clear on how this is accommodated and should have clear language about how dimensions are calculated, given that Medford's current zoning requires different

dimensions for different uses that could reasonably be accommodated in the same building. The consultant shall provide a rationale for which topics would be necessary or preferred for this document and the depth of detail warranted for each component given the complexities of the community. The end product shall be in a format that can be easily read and is visually pleasing.

5. **Design Standards:** The current zoning calls for Design Standards to be adopted by the Community Development Board, and it is anticipated that future zoning will utilize this as well. The consultant will work with the Community Development Board to develop appropriate design standards.

Given these needs, consultants should recommend a process for review and implementation of the changes needed by the City of Medford to reflect a modern zoning ordinance while responding to the urgent pressures of the need for residential, commercial and industrial development.

PROJECT PROCESS AND TIMELINE

1. Public Process

- a. ***Generate necessary background information.*** The City of Medford will provide all available maps, community-wide information, and existing land use plans as needed by the Consultant. These documents will be used to produce the maps, graphs, and general data that will be used during and for the preparation of the comprehensive update/revision. The City has adopted an electronic, GIS-based official zoning map that will be the basis of all work.
- b. ***Working with the Community Development Board:*** The Consultant will organize and lead a minimum of two meetings for each of the distinct remaining zoning sections with the Community Development Board, which will be open to the public pursuant to Open Meeting Law. These meetings will be used to work with the Community Development Board and relevant department heads as well as to engage the community, gather information, and formulate strategies.
- c. ***Working meetings with the City Council.*** The Consultant will organize and lead a minimum of two meetings for each of the distinct remaining zoning sections with the City Council, which will be open to the public pursuant to Open Meeting Law. These meetings will be used to work with the City Council and relevant department heads as well as to engage the community, gather information, and formulate strategies.
- d. ***Joint hearings with the City Council and Community Development Board.*** The Consultant will organize and lead a minimum of two (2) meetings for each of the distinct zoning sections jointly with the City Council and the Community

Development Board. These meetings are anticipated to be part of the formal Public Hearing Process as required by M.G.L. c.40a.

- e. **Public meetings.** In addition, the Zoning Consultant, in tandem with the Communications Consultant will lead two (2) workshops or meetings with the community for each of the distinct zoning areas. One workshop should be before zoning is drafted to hear public input on the desires for the area and a second meeting should be after there is drafted zoning, to obtain maximum community input so as to produce the best possible information on which to base the Zoning Ordinance revision. A charette-style engagement might be most appropriate for this meeting. It is not yet determined how many distinct areas the Residential zones should be broken up into, reflecting that the various residential areas in the city have very different built character, topography, microclimate, transit access, and infrastructure quality. The number of distinct residential areas will inform how many meetings are necessary for that portion. The format will also take into consideration the findings of the initial site analysis, input from staff, and information obtained at previous meetings, workshops, and interviews.
- f. **Presentation to the City Council.** At the conclusion of the workshops and meetings, the Consultant will present the work generated to-date to the City Council or a Steering Committee created by the City Council. Ideas that reflect those articulated in the workshops or meetings will be publicly presented and further feedback may be solicited from the community.

2. Internal Process

- a. **Meetings with working group.** The Consultant Team will meet biweekly on an internal working group consisting of non-quorums of elected officials, decisionmakers, and City Staff, for the purposes of discussing logistics and presenting preliminary versions of meeting materials.
- b. **Communication with staff.** The Consultant Team will be welcome to communicate as needed with planning staff to ensure general expert agreement with regards to draft zoning materials before presenting them to wider decisionmakers.

3. Refining the Regulations

- a. **Presentation of the First Drafts.** The Consultant will present the drafts of any and all Zoning Ordinance revision/updates for the purpose of gathering comments. Copies of the first drafts will need to be in hardcopy and digital form and posted on the City website. The presentation will be made to the City Council and may include other municipal boards and commissions, as determined by the City Council.

- b. *Presentation of the Second Drafts.* After making revisions in response to comments on the first drafts, the Consultant will present the second drafts of any and all Zoning Ordinance revision/updates at another meeting convened by the City Council.
- c. *Cover letters.* Each draft should be accompanied by a cover letter which should include information about what was changed, what else was considered, and where in the attached language to find that information. Anticipate that members of the Board will read the cover letter and review the zoning before the meeting.
- d. *Meetings with Stakeholders.* The Consultant will attend and participate in additional meetings with key stakeholders to explain the details of the draft Zoning Ordinance and obtain further input and comments.

4. Approval Process

- a. *Public Hearing Presentations.* The Consultant Team will make formal presentations to the City of Medford's Community Development Board and City Council as part of the required public hearings for adoption.
- b. *Additional Revisions.* The Consultant will be responsible for revisions to proposed zoning as needed, as well as producing a clean, accurate final product appropriate for legal adoption.

5. Anticipated Project Timeline

- a. Submittal Closing Date..... Dec 18, 2026
- b. 2-5 Consultants Selected for Presentation..... Jan 11, 2027
- c. Consultants Presentation/Interview..... January 2027
- d. Selection..... January 31, 2027
- e. Contract Approved/Plan Process Begins..... February 2027
- f. Zoning Ordinance Process Completed..... Ongoing through Jan 2030
- g. Public Hearings & Adoption..... Ongoing through Jan 2030

MINIMUM AND COMPARATIVE PROPOSAL CRITERIA

This RFP requires a separate and confidential submission of a Price Proposal and separate submission of a Technical Proposal. Technical Proposals will be evaluated by the review committee members. Review committee will be composed of City Council & Community Development Board members and City Staff.

The proposal evaluation and selection process will be (1) review technical proposals resulting in a score, (2) interviews if warranted, (3) references and (4) price.

The evaluation of each proposal for Services will be based upon the criteria described in this section. The City reserves the right to ask any proposer to provide additional supporting documentation in order to verify a response.

Ratings of Highly Advantageous (5); Advantageous (4); Acceptable (3); Not Advantageous (2); or Unresponsive (0) will be given to each of the following criteria for each proposer and a composite score created to rank the proposals.

A contractor may be deemed unacceptable if any of the criteria are scored as “Unresponsive (0)”

- A. Project Approach:** Describe the proposed approach to the project and a statement of project understanding, including an overview of the methodology and an acknowledgement and detailed plan encompassing the Scope of Services detailed above.

Highly advantageous (5): The project approach is detailed, clear, easy to understand, and meaningful to the City. It displays a deep understanding of project goals and components, with detailed methodology and plan. The plan includes all components of the Scope of Services and is aligned with project needs.

Advantageous (4): The project approach is detailed, clear, easy to understand, and meaningful to the City. It displays an understanding of project goals and components, with detailed methodology and plan. The plan includes all components of the Scope of Services and is aligned with project needs.

Acceptable (3): The project approach is adequate and meets all standard requirements.

Not Advantageous (2): The project approach does not demonstrate an understanding of project goals and is missing components of the Scope of Services.

Unresponsive (0): Did not include a project approach or stated it would be determined later

- B. Approach to working with Communications Consultant:** The city has put out an RFP for a communications consultant. Provide your approach for working with the consultant

Highly advantageous (5): The approach is detailed, clear and easy to understand. It displays a strong, thoughtful, and well-developed collaborative approach between consultants. The approach is tailored to the City’s needs.

Advantageous (4): The approach is detailed, clear and easy to understand. It displays a strong, collaborative approach between consultants.

Acceptable (3): The approach is adequate and meets all standard requirements.

Not Advantageous (2): The approach is not clear, lacks details, or does not reasonably align with the City's circumstances.

Unresponsive (0): Did not include an approach.

C. Project Schedule: Each consultant must submit a project schedule, including proposed dates for project milestones (e.g., meetings, products, etc.) assuming a contract target start date of February 1, 2027.

Highly advantageous (5): The project schedule is detailed, clear, and easy to understand. It includes all major and minor dates/milestones. The schedule aligns with municipal scheduling and displays opportunities for timeline flexibility.

Advantageous (4): The project schedule is clear and easy to understand. It includes all major and some minor dates/milestones.

Acceptable (3): The project schedule is clear and includes all major dates/milestones satisfactorily.

Not Advantageous (2): The project schedule is unclear and/or incomplete (did not include all major dates/milestones).

Unresponsive (0): Did not include a schedule or stated it would be determined later

D. Project Deliverables: Each consultant must submit a list of expected deliverables or other documents that the team will generate for the project, including but not limited to drafts of proposed revisions, final language of proposed revisions, public facing communications to explain proposed revisions, and a final document listing all revisions completed during the project period.

Highly advantageous (5): The list of expected deliverables is clear, easy to understand, and meaningful for the City. The applicant goes above the stated requirements in listing other documents the team will generate for the project, such as drafts of proposed revisions, final language of proposed revisions, public-facing communications to explain proposed revisions, and a final document listing all revisions completed during the project period.

Advantageous (4): The list of expected deliverables is clear, easy to understand, and meaningful for the City, or the applicant provides well-developed other documents that the team will generate for the project.

Acceptable (3): The list of expected deliverables is adequately outlined and meets all standard requirements.

Not Advantageous (2): The list of expected deliverables is not clearly outlined and there are notable limitations, gaps, or weaknesses that could impact the delivery of work products.

Unresponsive (0): Did not include a list of deliverables or stated it would be determined later.

E. Project Team: Identify key staff and their experience with neighborhood or area plans, particularly in communities similar to Medford, as well as regulatory and land use planning in Massachusetts. Indicate staff's availability to undertake this project beginning on or about February 1, 2027.

The project team combined shall have the following:

1. Member/s with a Master's degree in Planning, Architecture, or a closely related field;
2. Member/s with five years of professional experience in planning and zoning;
3. Member/s with experience writing and redesigning Zoning ordinance;
4. Member/s with legal expertise as needed to advise the City on zoning legal matters.

The proposer shall clearly identify sub-consultants, if any, and describe the contractual arrangements that will exist with all consultants. The proposal-submitting Consultant will be considered the prime contractor and will be fully responsible for the performance of any task pursuant to this contract, including the quality and timeliness of work performed by any consultant.

Highly advantageous (5): The statement of qualifications demonstrates superior experience in providing services related to the City's requirements. The project proposal demonstrates a wide depth of experience with similar projects (7 or more), and prior experience with conducting community outreach meetings; public projects that require coordination between multiple city departments, boards, city council, or similar municipal entities; consulting on and drafting municipal ordinances, with Massachusetts zoning ordinances given the most weight. Project work samples are of outstanding quality in content and technical presentation.

Advantageous (4): The statement of qualifications demonstrates solid experience in providing services related to the City's requirements. The project proposal demonstrates a good depth of experience with similar projects (4 to 7), and prior experience with conducting community outreach meetings; public projects that require coordination between multiple city departments, boards, city council, or similar municipal entities; consulting on and drafting municipal ordinances, with zoning ordinances given the most weight. Project work samples are of good quality in content and technical presentation.

Acceptable (3): The statement of qualifications demonstrates some experience in providing services related to the City’s requirements. The project proposal demonstrates experience with similar projects (4 to 5), and prior experience with conducting community outreach meetings; public projects that require coordination between multiple city departments, boards, city council, or similar municipal entities; consulting on and drafting municipal ordinances, with zoning ordinances given the most weight. Project work samples are satisfactory in content and technical presentation.

Not Advantageous (2): The proposer has limited experience in providing services related to the City’s requirements or with similar projects (fewer than 4), and prior experience with consulting on and drafting municipal ordinances, including zoning ordinances.. Project work samples minimally meet current standards for content and technical presentation.

Unresponsive (0): Has not completed any zoning ordinance related work or projects similar in scope.

In addition, proposers shall provide with their Technical Proposals the following lists and completed documents:

1. Resumes for all project personnel including those listed above.
2. List of similar work previously completed by the consultant(s).
3. Contact information of at least three (3) references for whom the consultant has previously performed work.
4. Bidder’s Qualifications and References Form
5. Non-Collusion Form
6. Certificate of Corporate Authority (if applicable)
7. Debarment Letter
8. IRS W-9 Form

PRICE PROPOSAL

Proposers shall use “**ATTACHMENT A**” to this **RFP #24-0049** in submitting its Price Proposal. Please remember to submit your Price Proposal in a **separately sealed marked envelope**. Any Technical Proposal with prices included will be deemed unresponsive. Price Proposals will be opened only after evaluation of all Technical Proposals is complete. Project fees shall reflect the hourly rate for services to be provided.

PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW

The top finalists will be invited for an interview/presentation with City Council and City staff members.

SUBMISSION INFORMATION

Seven (7) bound copies of the Technical Proposal is required to be delivered to the Office of Procurement, Room 105, Attention Fiona Maxwell on or before **December 18, 2026 at 12:00 PM**

Commented [AH3]: Fiona to review this section

Commented [AH4]: We need to know how many people want hard copies

Additionally, electronica proposals will be received until: **December 18, 2026 at 12:00 PM** via <https://www.bidnetdirect.com/massachusetts/cityofmedford>

Award will be made to the most advantageous proposer for consulting services based on the recommendation of the Evaluating Committee.

The term of the contract **shall extend for three years.**

All proposals are subject to the provisions of M.G.L. c.30B, §6.

The City can reject any and all bids in accordance with the above referenced General Laws. In addition, the City reserves the right to waive minor informalities in any or all bids, or to reject any or all bids (in whole or in part) if it be in the public interest to do so.